

What is hardware?

When talking about computers, people often refer to hardware, particularly in terms of upgrading or replacing it. Hardware combines with software to form a usable computing system.

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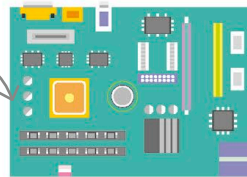
Basic hardware

Hardware is everything in, or connected to, a computer that's part of the physical world and can be touched. This includes the computer itself, with a screen, keyboard, and mouse. It also includes devices connected to a computer, such as speakers and memory cards. The computer's internal components are considered hardware as well.

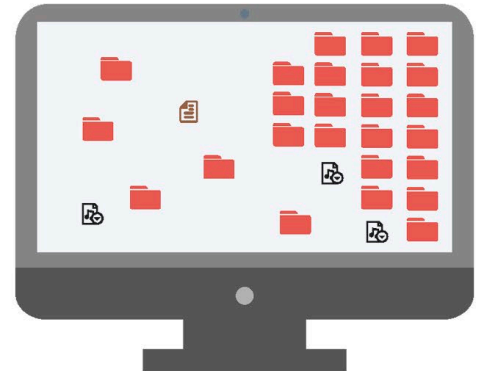
All electronic components in a computer are connected to a circuit board called a motherboard.

▷ Internal and external hardware

Users constantly interact with external hardware devices like keyboards. Unless you have expert knowledge or assistance, it's recommended not to touch the internal hardware.



Motherboard



Monitor

Types of hardware device

Hardware devices are grouped into several categories. They can either be integral to the computer (such as a motherboard) or attached to it via cables, Wi-Fi, or Bluetooth. Hardware devices that aren't an integral part of the main computer unit, such as keyboards, mice, screens, printers, and scanners are called peripherals. Mobile phones and tablets usually have integrated hardware devices and don't need peripherals. Here are some common hardware devices.



Scanner



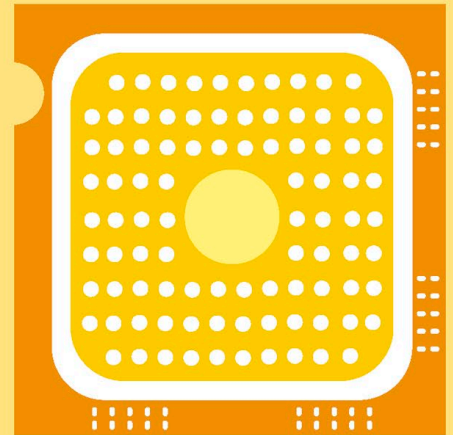
Keyboard



Camera

△ Input devices

These devices are used to input data or instructions. Some input devices, such as scanners and cameras, allow the input of digitized information that can be stored or processed.



Processing chip

△ Processing devices

These devices take data and instructions to produce new variations of data. Computers may also have specialized processing devices that deal with graphics or audio and video signals.